

CYAN DING

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, Berkeley, CA
B.S. Bioengineering

Aug. 2025-present

Davis Senior High School, Davis, CA
GPA 4.458, SAT 1530

Aug. 2022-June 2025

HACKATHON EXPERIENCE

Cal Hacks | *Regeneration Track: 1st Place*

Oct. 24, 2025

- Built TrialScope AI, an AI-powered full-stack web app to review clinical trial protocols and derive actionable insights, improving likelihood of trial success.
- Trained an ML model to predict trial length, leveraged AI to ensure FDA compliance, and computed similarity scores against similar trials on clinicaltrials.gov.

AgentMail YC Hack Halloween | *Best Use Perplexity, 2nd Best Use Convex*

Oct. 31, 2025

- Built Athena, the Agentic Bloomberg Terminal. Used Perplexity and Browser-Use for financial news curation, Convex for backend, AgentMail for opportunistic investing, Hyperspell for agent memory, and Alpaca for paper trading.

Redwood Research Alignment Faking Hackathon | *Red Team 2nd Place*

Sep. 13, 2025

- Fine tuned Gemma 27B to create a model organism “Crashout” to fake alignment when observed.
- Generated 10k+ input-output examples with jailbroken models and evaluated the model organism with AI Security Institute’s Inspect AI framework.

ROBOTICS EXPERIENCE

FIRST Robotics Team 1678 | *Software Scouting Lead*

June 2021-Aug. 2025

- Led team of 15 to develop Kotlin-based Android apps, Python-based server management, and design of the team's scouting system. This system provided strategic insights for picking teams during alliance selection, contributing to 1678 placing 3rd at Worlds (2024).
- Wrote a white paper on scouting systems read by 10k+ people every year.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Boston University RISE Internship Program

June 2024-Aug. 2024

- Wrote a neuroscience paper that was published in the Curieux Academic Journal’s June issue.
- Worked with Professor Kyle Gobrogge on a project investigating serotonin's role in depression and sex differences in depression utilizing the *Drosophila melanogaster* model organism. Gained experience with the Gal4-UAS system to create selective fly crosses, optogenetics to activate serotonergic neurons, fluorescent microscopy to image fluorescent protein tags on channelrhodopsin and halorhodopsin proteins, and fruit fly brain dissections.

SKILLS

Coding: LLM agents & RAG (Python), mobile app dev (Kotlin), back-end (PostgreSQL), front end (Next.js)

Hobbies: Classically trained Bb clarinet player, ping pong, billiards, lifting